



Launch Planning Evaluation

Estimated Duration: 45 minutes

Objectives

- Review an updated product development scenario
- Analyze launch planning
- Recommend follow-up actions

Prerequisites

- You must have Microsoft Word installed on your computer or a Microsoft Office 365 account online.
- Ensure you reviewed the following videos:
 - Video: Product Development
 - Video: Product Requirements Refinement and Verification

Product Development Scenario

Stay Cool LLC (SC) is a moderately sized firm that operates out of Miami, Florida. They specialize in creating tailored heating, ventilation, and air conditioning (HVAC) systems for mobile vehicles. One of their largest customers is the military.

SC recently won a large contract to replace faulty HVAC systems in a large fleet of armored vehicles. They deployed the vehicle fleet to a desert environment and found the currently installed HVAC systems to be inadequate.

The Product Manager's name is Anita Mansfield. Anita guided the way through the Develop phase, overseeing the development of several military and commercial prototypes. SC believes this product is suitable for multiple buyers and users both in military and commercial use such as trains, ships, and other vehicles that must operate in high-temperature environment. Anita is leading the product launch planning efforts.

The initial launch to the primary military users is in three months. However, the team approved to build multiple prototypes that can suit a wide variety of both

military and commercial users. The plan is to phase these launches over the next six months.

Anita is working closely with the marketing team to communicate to potential military and commercial buyers that a new, next-generation mobile HVAC system will be available with functionalities and features no competitor can match. They are positioning their product line based on the fact that no competitor can match the size, efficiency, and durability of this system, along with its ease of installation. The entire team agrees that the current messaging methodology and positioning strategy is highly effective and will yield results.

The good news is that they have scheduled a series of presentation events with potential military buyers and users. It includes those who have contracted for the new system and other's who are considering adoption. However, demand generation activities to support commercial users are lagging.

Pricing considerations are still up in the air. Anita and her team are not sure of pricing for the variety of systems they will develop and if any discounts or promotions will follow.

They were under the impression that this new HVAC mobile capability was for military use only. They were unaware that this system could adapt to commercial vehicles. They recommended that the marketing team begin preparing sales tools and marketing collateral immediately.

This new system has not been widely advertised. Besides the military, there is little knowledge of SC's breakthrough system development. Marketing wants to get the word out and conduct some focus groups and demos with industry analysts to gain their feedback and hopefully positive reviews.

Next month, there is a scheduled beta plan involving key military buyers and users. Although well-coordinated with established schedules, there is no inclusion of potential commercial buyers and users in the beta testing. The plan requires modification.

Exercise

Step 1: Keeping the CTRL key pressed, click [here](#) to download the MS Word file entitled **Product EOL Scenarios Worksheet**.

Note: Use the COMMAND key instead of CTRL on Mac systems.

Step 2: Use the Launch Planning Checklist to determine what was accomplished well in the scenario, and what problems were encountered. Strive to identify at least five issues.

Step 3: Document at least five launch planning issues. Annotate them after you complete the checklist.

Step 4: Save this file. This file can become part of a growing personal portfolio you can build to share new skills, tools, and techniques you learn in this course with peers, your team leadership, or external associates. A personal portfolio highlights your skills to those in your current organization, or future organizations where you may seek employment.